PCAO-F PREP | EXPLAINER

AI Fluency and Scenarios

Decide. Describe. Check. Own.

Delegation | Description | Discernment | Diligence

How to work with AI well, and how to read a scenario and find what went wrong.

Based on the deck "AI Fluency: the 4Ds" (The AI Agent Factory by Panaversity)

AI fluency: what it is

PART 2/7

Decide. Describe. Check. Own.

What it means

Working with AI systems in ways that are:

- **Effective**
  you actually reach your goal
- **Efficient**
  no wasted time, tokens or energy
- **Ethical**
  honest about AI's role, fair to others
- **Safe**
  privacy and security protected

A durable skill set, not a collection of prompt tricks.

Before you start

1. **Know the work yourself**
   Domain expert first, AI delegator second. AI speeds up expertise; it rarely replaces it.
2. **Know what AI is**
   It continues text from patterns and does not look answers up. So plausible is not correct, answers vary, and its knowledge has a cutoff.
3. **Know your limits**
   Use approved tools and data, and decide who owns the result before you begin.

A powerful AI still gives the wrong result when the collaboration is poor.

The 4Ds: four questions

PART 3/7

Ask these around every piece of AI work

Delegation

Decide

What should AI do, and what should stay with me?

Before AI starts

Description

Explain

What does AI need to know to do the work well?

Before AI starts

Discernment

Check

Is the result actually good and trustworthy?

After AI answers

Diligence

Own

Is this a responsible way to use AI, and am I ready to own the result?

All the way through

The 10-80-10 rule: where the human stands



First 10%
Human sets the direction: delegate and describe.

Middle 80%
AI executes within the direction already set.

Final 10%
Human verifies and takes responsibility.

Delegate it. Describe it. Let AI do it. Discern it. Own it.

Before AI starts: Delegation and Description

PART 4/7

Choose the job first, then explain it completely

DELEGATION

Decide: what should AI do, and what stays with me?

1. **Problem awareness**
   Know the goal and what success looks like.

2. **Platform awareness**
   Know what AI can and cannot do, and choose the tool that fits.

3. **Task delegation**
   Divide the work, and give each part an owner with a reason.

DESCRIPTION

Explain: what does AI need to know?

1. **Product**
   What you want: output, format, audience, length, style.

2. **Process**
   How to approach it: steps, order, examples to follow.

3. **Performance**
   How AI should behave with you: concise or detailed, challenging or supportive.

The best prompt is not clever. It is complete.

After AI answers: Discernment and Diligence

PART 5/7

Judge the result, then decide whether and how to use it

DISCERNMENT

Check: is the result good and trustworthy?

1. **Product**
   Is the result any good? Check it against what you asked and against sources.

2. **Process**
   Is this way of working paying off, or are you fixing the same mistakes?

3. **Performance**
   Are people well served when you are not watching?

DILIGENCE

Own: is this a responsible way to use AI?

1. **Creation (before)**
   Choose tools and data responsibly.

2. **Transparency (during)**
   Be honest about AI's role with everyone affected.

3. **Deployment (after)**
   Verify and vouch before anything ships.

"Would I confidently put my name on this?" If not, it does not ship.

Example 1: Hira's academy

PART 6/7

Read the story, break it into 5 parts, then find the failed D

THE STORY

Hira runs Sunrise Academy in Karachi, an evening academy with 120 students in grades 8 to 10. Results have been disappointing and a parents' meeting is next week, so she asks an AI assistant: "Make a plan to improve my academy's results." The AI returns a polished 12-point plan: gamified apps, a parent portal, motivation seminars and new branding. Hira decides it is generic, uses none of it, and tells her staff that "AI is useless." She never said what "results" meant, whether marks, pass rate or attendance, and her own records, which she did not open, show Grade 9 maths at a 58% pass rate.

Break it into the 5 parts

1 Company

Sunrise Academy, Karachi. 120 students, grades 8 to 10, evening classes.

2 Problem

Results are disappointing and a parents' meeting is next week.

3 Actions

She asked: "Make a plan to improve my academy's results."

4 Workflow

A polished 12-point plan came back. She used none of it.

5 Hidden clue

"Results" was never defined, and her own records were never opened.

Symptom: a polished plan that is generic and unusable. Ask the four questions in order:

Delegation — FAILED

She never chose the problem or what AI should do. The job was not defined.

Description — PAUSED

Cannot be tested yet. You cannot describe a job you have not defined.

Discernment — PASSED

She judged well: she saw it was generic and did not ship it.

Diligence — PASSED

Nothing in the story shows a data or disclosure problem.

The fix: go back to the earliest failed D

Define the problem from her own data: raise the Grade 9 maths pass rate from 58% to 70%. Split the work: AI analyses anonymised score tables and drafts practice sets; Hira chooses the teaching changes and approves. Then describe it, and check each idea against her data.

Example 2: Imran's supplier quotes

PART 7/7

Same method as before, and this time a different D fails

THE STORY

Imran exports garments to Europe and must choose one fabric supplier tonight. He gives an AI assistant three quotes and a complete brief: a table with fabric, stitching, freight, duties and the total landed cost for each supplier. The AI returns a clean table in which Supplier B has the lowest total, USD 17,550.30, so Imran places the order. The next day his accountant finds that B's four cost lines add up to USD 18,462.30, which is USD 912 more, and that Supplier A at USD 18,010.00 was actually cheaper. Every line item was right. Only the total was wrong.

Break it into the 5 parts

1 Company

Imran exports garments to Europe.

2 Problem

He must choose one fabric supplier tonight.

3 Actions

A complete brief: 3 quotes, every cost line, and the total landed cost.

4 Workflow

A clean table. B shows the lowest total, USD 17,550.30, so he orders from B.

5 Hidden clue

B's lines add up to 18,462.30. Only the total was wrong, and nobody recomputed it.

Symptom: every line item was right, yet the decision was wrong. Ask the four questions in order:

Delegation — PASSED

Clear job: pick a supplier tonight. AI compares, Imran decides.

Description — PASSED

A complete brief. A longer prompt would not fix a wrong sum.

Discernment — FAILED

He trusted a polished total and did not recompute it.

Diligence — PASSED

Nothing in the story shows a data or disclosure problem.

The fix: numbers are computed, never generated

Any number a decision rests on must be computed, not predicted by the AI. Ask it to run the sum in a spreadsheet or code and show you, then check the decisive figure against the quotes before ordering. Verify what the decision depends on, not everything equally.